# RCS Travels — law, documents and product contradictions

Reviewed 1 November 2026, India time. Operating scope confirmed by the owner: **Uttar Pradesh, Delhi, Haryana, Punjab, Rajasthan, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, and Jammu & Kashmir.**

The installed RCS Legal Workbench was applied to **51 document units**: eight canonical policies, 24 locale policies, eight November candidates, nine support knowledge documents and two PDF packs. Every English route differs from the canonical source; all 16 Hindi/Hinglish route comparisons have structural, marker or figure drift. These counts describe differences against a newer source revision, not proof that every translation is linguistically wrong.

**No policy, charge, account rule or production setting has been changed by this audit.** The decisions below are for the owner. A document change does not implement a missing operational control. Mandatory rows require a compliant implementation or a lawful change in operating scope/model; owner-choice rows identify optional policies.

## Document contradictions

| ID / type | What the law says | What RCS currently has | Decision / correction needed |
|---|---|---|---|
| **D01 — Confirmed version drift** | Applicable consumer disclosures must be clear and accurate; affirmative purchase consent is required. 2020 rules 4(2), 4(3), 4(9). | `LegalPage.jsx:25-26` prefers locale JSON over `legal.js`. All eight English route objects differ. Hindi/Hinglish are also based on an older structure. Updating constants alone does not update the ordinary rendered policy. | Choose one adopted policy version, then reconcile constants, all locales, PDFs and support knowledge together. Keep unresolved candidates labelled until the underlying decisions are made. |
| **D02 — Obsolete September PDF** | Advance and cancellation charge are separate. A cancellation cap does not prescribe an advance percentage. | The old 17-page PDF says **15% advance** and describes retaining the advance. Current scheduled-payment code uses **10% with rounding** and the fee is separately capped. The November PDF is a different, unadopted candidate. | Retire the September PDF from any customer/payment-provider use. Regenerate an adopted replacement after decisions below; do not treat its 15% as current product behaviour. |
| **D03 — Wrong/missing business identity in rendered text** | See the current disclosure duty in D01. | Canonical and November documents identify the owner and address; rendered English still contains registered-name/legal-form/address placeholders. The owner has confirmed the actual details. | Replace the stale identity fields consistently. Do not invent a company registration or tax number. This correction is factual and does not settle business-model eligibility in J01. |
| **D04 — Rider age conflict; owner choice** | Contract Act §11 concerns contractual capacity. DPDP distinguishes under-18 data subjects, with substantive duties phased in. Contract Act, DPDP Act §§2, 9. | Canonical/RAG drafts say **15+ accounts**; locale wording leaves the age unresolved; November candidates propose **18+ account holders** and adult-accompanied children. Signup is not evidenced as enforcing that proposal. | Choose **adult accounts with accompanied minors**, or a properly designed guardian/consent model. A blanket 18+ passenger age is not established by these sources. The previous candidate's accompanied-child rule was a proposal, not a statutory rule or your approved decision. |

| ID / type | What the law says | What RCS currently has | Decision / correction needed |
|---|---|---|---|
| **D05 — Captain cancellation and refund promise** | Accepted refunds must be paid within a reasonable/applicable period; misleading service promises must be corrected. 2020 rules 4(3), 4(10). | Some legal copy promises a refund when a driver cancels. Current `driverRideCancellation.js:6-20` supports assigned/en-route/arrived cancellation and returns the same booking to matching/confirmed; the scheduled advance remains attached. New RAG and November copy explain replacement. | Choose whether captain cancellation keeps replacement matching open or ends the rider booking. Show the rider the choice and a clear refund route. Change both code and disclosures if the booking-ending behaviour changes. |
| **D06 — Stale captain sanctions** | A cancellation allegation and a final responsibility finding are different facts; use the applicable transport procedure and accurate terms. | Earlier documents describe raw-complaint strikes and old cancellation/loyalty thresholds. Current `driverCancellations.js:80-118` records a reason-aware incident and opens `NEEDS_ADMIN_REVIEW`; newer notice/appeal/financial services exist. `CONTEXT.md` still says production consequences are OFF. | Adopt and publish the current reviewed process, thresholds, notice and appeal windows after verifying deployment. Do not restore old automatic raw-complaint penalties merely to match an old PDF. |

## Verified law versus product / operational evidence

UP-specific rows apply when the described RCS activity falls within the final UP rules. The actual service model and local fleet facts must be established; the source is the **final 22 May 2026 notification**, not the March consultation. The legal summaries below are intentionally brief; each citation identifies the full rule and page for inspection.

| ID / classification | What the law says | What RCS currently has | Decision / action needed |
|---|---|---|---|
| **L01 — Current duty; draft correction** | Covered entities: acknowledge consumer complaints in **48 hours**, redress within **one month**. 2020 rule 4(5). | Current legal/RAG text leaves deadlines pending. The November rider grievance candidate calls these only a proposed service standard. That legal characterisation needs correction. Actual manual handling records were not inspected. | Establish a tracked intake, named handler and deadline monitoring. Replace the suggestion that an applicable statutory deadline can wait for policy adoption. Captain service targets need a separate applicability analysis. |
| **L02 — Ordinary captain cancellation; source uncertainty resolved** | UP 125-V(1): unjustified cancellation → **min(10% total fare, ₹100)**; equal next-booking rider concession. Final rule. | Canonical text still calls the amount unresolved. Current financial services support this formula for a finalized driver-caused ordinary cancellation, with review/appeal lineage. Production activation and delivery were not verified. | Correct the old uncertainty. Decide the disclosed valid reasons, review/appeal process and funded rider-credit operations; verify the existing implementation before describing it as live. |
| **L03 — Confirmed unsupported case family** | UP 125-V(2): specified **10-minute non-reporting** cancellation → **₹100**, equal next-booking concession. Final rule. | Rider delay reasons can waive the rider fee. But `responsibilityFinancialPolicy.js:16-19` explicitly classifies `FAILED_PICKUP` as `NOT_YET_SAFE`; driver-late finance is also blocked. The ordinary percentage formula is not the flat failed-pickup rule. | Implement the distinct event, expected-time evidence, refund handling and ₹100 credit/recovery path. Do not activate an unsupported financial family simply by changing its flag. |

| ID / classification | What the law says | What RCS currently has | Decision / action needed |
|---|---|---|---|
| **L04 — Confirmed collection/allocation mismatch** | UP 125-V(3): rider charge recovered with **next booking's fare**, split under 125-U. Final rule. | RCS currently deducts a qualifying charge from the scheduled advance immediately, and `customerCancellation.js:48-57` credits **all** of that amount to the assigned captain. The amount cap alone does not settle timing or allocation. | Resolve the UP-compliant recovery and sharing design before changing money flows. Preserve existing refund/accounting records. Get an authoritative basis if proposing a different recovery method; a policy disclaimer alone does not resolve the text difference. |
| **L05 — Cancellation symmetry needs evidence** | Covered e-commerce entities charging consumers must bear similar charges for their own unilateral cancellations. 2020 rule 4(8). | Rider fee rules are specified; a platform-unilateral-cancellation charge/remedy is not established. A captain incident is not automatically the same legal event as a platform cancellation. | Define platform, captain and rider cancellation separately and implement applicable remedies. Do not assume rematching, a driver penalty or refund alone answers the symmetry requirement. |
| **L06 — Daily settlement gap; percentage alone not a violation** | UP 125-U(5)-(6): owner-driver **≥80%, daily**; platform-owned vehicle driver **≥60%**. Final rule. | Code has 0%/10% commission with an ₹800 eligible-driving-fare threshold and pass-through exclusions. A nominal 90% driver share is not itself below 80%. Actual fare basis, deductions, ownership and daily settlement are not verified; candidate declines to state a cycle. | Keep or revise the commercial commission only after checking mandatory net share and daily settlement for the relevant model. Confirm ownership and reconcile cash, direct UPI and ledger payouts. |
| **L07 — Onboarding evidence gap** | UP 125-M requires identity, experience, medical/psychological and police checks. Final rule. | Document approval covers DL/vehicle paperwork. `driverDocuments.js:5-7` expressly excludes police verification. No matching medical/experience/identity-verification evidence workflow was found in the scoped code. External checks were not verified. | Establish the required checks and records, whether manual or integrated. Confirm what is actually performed before adding a compliance claim to captain terms. |
| **L08 — Vehicle-document contradiction** | UP 125-Q(1)(e) requires a valid **PUC**. Final rule. | Privacy/terms mention PUC where applicable, but `backend/constants/driverDocuments.js` has no PUC document type or approval/expiry gate. Vehicle fitness is a different document. | Add or demonstrate a real PUC verification/renewal process. Correct data-collection statements if PUC is not currently collected. |
| **L09 — Training and cover evidence gap** | UP: **40-hour induction; passenger ₹5 lakh; driver health ₹5 lakh and term/accident ₹10 lakh**, subject to the stated social-security interaction. 125-K, 125-J(7), 125-N. | Candidates avoid claiming that training or cover is supplied, but no verified training/cover records were provided. An ordinary vehicle insurance upload does not establish every required passenger, health and accident benefit. | Verify actual arrangements, limits and evidence, including current social-security provisions. Omitting a promise does not establish fulfilment of an applicable duty. |
| **L10 — Safety operations gap** | UP 125-R(13),(15) require **24×7 control room/call centre**. Final rule. | RCS has phone/email/WhatsApp support links. Candidates expressly avoid promising continuous staffing; no continuous-control-room evidence was verified. Calling 112 remains sensible emergency guidance. | Confirm and implement the required operations for covered services. A 112 disclaimer cannot substitute for the operator's separate duty. |

| ID / classification | What the law says | What RCS currently has | Decision / action needed |
|---|---|---|---|
| **L11 — Immediate safety restriction needs reconciliation** | UP 125-R(11): specified intoxication complaint → immediate off-boarding pending inquiry. Final rule. | Captain terms discuss general proportionate restrictions and review. A complaint-specific immediate route, trained reviewer and live enforcement were not demonstrated. | Design the required protective route with notice, inquiry and correction safeguards; separate provisional protection from a final fault finding. |
| **L12 — Retention wording too generic** | UP 125-R(5): listed app data **3–12 months**. Final rule. | Privacy candidates say records have differing needs but publish no category schedule. Rider/captain deletion preserves linked booking, wallet and audit records. No category purge schedule was found in the scoped routes/services. Other worktree retention research is outside this audit. | Approve a record-category schedule, legal holds and deletion jobs. Separate trip/location data from tax, security and dispute records; do not globally erase every record at 12 months or retain everything indefinitely. |
| **L13 — Security obligations need separate evidence** | Covered organisations: listed incidents **six hours**; ICT logs **180 days in India**. CERT-In directions (ii),(iv). | Generic privacy security text and provider integrations do not prove log geography, retention, incident classification or reporting readiness. No production configuration or incident records were inspected. | Assign incident responsibility and verify log storage/retention. This requirement concerns the specified logs; it is not a blanket India-only rule for every database record. |
| **L14 — Hindi contract / acceptance evidence gap** | UP 125-M(1)(i): executed driver agreement in the **State language**, standard terms online. Final rule. | November candidates are English. Hindi legal catalogs are stale. Native Legal opens website URLs; no policy-version acceptance ledger was found in the scoped signup/schema inspection. A terms link alone is not evidence of an executed agreement. | Adopt a correct Hindi agreement and a durable acceptance/version mechanism. A checkbox is one possible interface; the legal need is demonstrable agreement and appropriate consent. |
| **L15 — Tax model unresolved; direct payment is relevant** | Notified cab services can place GST liability on the operator. Direct participant payments are included by applicable e-commerce TDS provisions. GST notification 17/2017, Income-tax Act 2025 §393. | Final UPI can go directly to a captain; commission/wallet code is implemented. GST/TDS classification, applicable thresholds, invoices and remittance records were not established by the scoped code. | Determine the actual supply/payment model, current tax provisions and exceptions. Direct UPI or cash is not, by itself, a tax exemption. The 1961 Act's §194-O is historical terminology for current-year analysis; verify the 2025 Act mapping before specifying a rate. |

## Future duties and questions that remain open

| ID | Law / timing | What RCS has | Decision |
|---|---|---|---|
| **F01 — 1 January 2027** | The final 2026 amendment adds complaint copies, mandatory NCH convergence and other transparency duties from that date. G.S.R. 789(E), rule 1 and amendments to rule 4. | Candidates propose a complaint record/copy and explicitly avoid claiming NCH membership. Actual readiness is not established. | Assign an owner and dated readiness work. The existing 48-hour/one-month timing in L01 already applies where covered. |

| ID | Law / timing | What RCS has | Decision |
|---|---|---|---|
| **F02 — DPDP phasing** | Substantive DPDP duties have an eighteen-month commencement phase; other provisions start earlier. Commencement notification, rule 1. | Current notices say preparation is underway. No complete notice/consent/child-data/request/processor inventory was verified. Existing IT/SPDI duties still need assessment now. | Plan for the applicable commencement dates, including children and erasure, without describing every DPDP duty as already operative. Phasing is not proof that all present privacy obligations disappear. |
| **F03 — Refund target; owner choice inside legal bounds** | The accepted-refund standard in D05 is reasonable/applicable timing; it does not establish a universal seven-day bank-credit guarantee. | Candidate deliberately states no universal credit deadline. No approved initiation service target or tested provider-specific window is established. | Choose an achievable initiation/follow-up target and disclose provider-specific expectations. Keep initiation, processing and actual bank credit distinct. |
| **F04 — Missing exact operating facts** | State scope and vehicle ownership can change requirements; the territory matrix below explains the verified differences. | Eight pickup jurisdictions are now confirmed, but fleet counts by territory, ownership, counterparties, actual staffing and current permits/authorisations were not independently verified. | Provide a factual inventory. Do not choose an exemption solely from an old approximate fleet count or a website form's eligibility text. |

## Eight-territory matrix

This is a source-backed scope check, not certification of state-by-state operations. An All India vehicle permit does not establish that every platform, pickup, tax, safety or local condition is satisfied.

| Territory | Verified source / what it establishes | What RCS has / decision needed |
|---|---|---|
| **Uttar Pradesh — J01** | Final 125-C has its own scope; 125-I lists company/LLP/qualifying co-operative eligibility. Final order. | Owner confirms a proprietorship. For the described driver-matching platform, entity/operating-model eligibility is a substantive issue. Establish a lawful structure/model and required operating prerequisites; keep public documents free of unsupported approval claims. The source does not establish a general small-fleet exemption. |
| **Delhi — J02** | Clause 3(1) contains an **at-least-25-associated-vehicle** threshold; clause 3(2) preserves other law. Final 2023 scheme. | Delhi pickups confirmed; current fleet counting and model facts unverified. Do not copy the threshold to UP or conclude every other duty disappears below it. Check subsequent Delhi conditions before adoption. |
| **Haryana — J03** | Official site lists a **21 May 2026** policy; a December 2025 Rule 86A amendment also exists. Current policy entry. | Latest attachment retrieval remained unsuccessful. Do not certify Haryana scope/exemption using the older text or snippets. Obtain the current attachment and reconcile its requirements. |
| **Punjab — J04** | Official index and downloaded attachment identify **14 December 2023 draft rules**. Official attachment. | Punjab pickups confirmed. A current final state instrument was not established. Verify final status and applicable central/local conditions; a draft is not operative proof and missing verification is not permission. |

| Territory | Verified source / what it establishes | What RCS has / decision needed |
|---|---|---|
| **Rajasthan — J05** | Final rule 3 contains **at least 25 vehicles**; applicant definition includes individuals and other forms. 2025 scheme, rules 2–3. | Rajasthan pickups confirmed. Its entity and fleet language differs from UP. Establish counting/model facts and applicable conditions instead of using one nationwide assumption. |
| **Uttarakhand — J06** | The official library supplies the 2020 on-demand rules and 2024 amendment. Their scope/definitions were visually inspected in the scans. Official index, 2024 amendment. | Uttarakhand pickups confirmed. Apply the amended definitions and conditions, rather than the superseded 2019 consultation or UP-only terms. Full remaining clause-level reconciliation is open. |
| **Himachal Pradesh — J07** | A current final state-specific aggregator instrument was not verified in this pass. No legal exemption is inferred. | Himachal pickups confirmed. Obtain current written state requirements and applicable permit/fare conditions. This row is an unresolved source question, not a confirmed breach or a finding that no rules exist. |
| **Jammu & Kashmir — J08** | Final S.O. 453 of 29 August 2023 applies to UT operations; rule 5 lists eligible entity forms. Official scanned rules, page 4. | Owner confirms proprietorship and J&K pickups. Entity/model reconciliation is required; check current amendments/conditions as well. The official scan's commencement and eligibility pages were visually inspected, not inferred from failed OCR. |

## What is already consistent in the inspected code

- A scheduled advance is part-payment, with 10% server calculation/rounding, rather than an extra fee. A zero required advance can confirm without checkout.
- A qualifying scheduled rider cancellation is capped at 10%, ₹100 and the amount actually paid. Disclosed valid reasons waive it. See L04 for the separate UP recovery/allocation issue; a matching numerical cap does not settle that.
- A changed cancellation quote requires reconfirmation. The service does not silently charge the revised higher amount in the inspected route.
- The candidate's rejection of an unlimited indemnity is protective wording, despite the lexical scanner flagging those words. It was reviewed in context.
- New financial responsibility services distinguish reviewed incidents from mere raw complaints. Their existence does not establish production activation.

## Tools, evidence and validation

- Updated and successfully installed **RCS Legal Workbench 0.1.1**, preserving its identity and upstream Apache attribution. The earlier same-version reinstall encountered a Windows cache access error; installing the new patch succeeded.
- All **11 plugin tests pass**, including actual stdio initialization, discovery and calls to all eight tools. The project audit uses that installed library.
- The unmodified locale test first failed on Node's extensionless import. A narrow audit-only resolver reproduces Vite resolution; the test then **fails substantively on English-source drift**. No assertion was weakened and no production import was changed.
- The audit caches public primary PDFs, hashes and extraction provenance. Important UP/consumer clauses and selected scanned J&K/Uttarakhand pages were inspected visually. Scanned documents are not treated as empty/no-law sources.

- No customer records, captain records, credentials, production database, provider transaction or deployed configuration were accessed. Manual staffing, external cover/checks, deployed permissions and actual operating records remain unverified. Absence of a repository workflow does not prove an external process is absent.

Use [DECISIONS.md](DECISIONS.md) for the choices to answer, and [tool-results.json](tool-results.json) for all 51 scans and route-level differences. [source-register.json](source-register.json) records downloaded URLs and hashes; `snapshots/` contains the exact policy text reviewed. No adoption or legal clearance is implied by a text match, successful tool call or this audit.

# RCS owner decisions

Read the corresponding ID in [the audit](README.md) before answering. These choices do not authorise automatic code, money-flow or publication changes.

| Decision | Choices / facts needed | What is mandatory versus optional |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Rider accounts and children — D04** | A: adult account holders, children accompanied by an adult. B: support minors through a properly designed guardian/consent and travel-safety flow. State any other proposed child-travel model explicitly. | The accompanied-child wording in the candidate was my proposal. A universal 18+ passenger rule was not established. Contracting capacity and applicable child-data protections must be respected. |
| **2. Captain cancels — D05** | A: keep matching, with a clear rider choice to cancel/refund. B: end the booking and refund rather than rematch. Define when replacement attempts end. | Actual product and refund promises must match. Mandatory missed-pickup and cancellation remedies remain separate. |
| **3. Cancellation recovery — L02–L05** | Decide the operational design for ordinary captain fault, the distinct failed-pickup case, rider recovery/allocation and platform cancellation. Specify evidence/review and how credits are funded. | Apply the operative rules for each territory. The UP clauses are resolved source text, rather than optional penalty amounts. A shorter text cannot fix incompatible recovery timing/allocation. |
| **4. Captain economics — L06** | Confirm vehicle ownership, current commission policy, fare basis, pass-through costs, cash/direct-UPI handling and settlement timing. | The current nominal 10% commission is not itself a below-80% violation. Applicable minimum shares and daily settlement conditions still govern. |
| **5. Support ownership — L01, L10, F01** | Who handles incoming complaints and deadline tracking? What records demonstrate acknowledgement/redress? What arrangements serve the required operating hours for covered services? | Applicable grievance timing and safety operations cannot be treated as merely optional proposed targets. Future 2027 additions need their own readiness work. |
| **6. Refund service target — F03** | Choose an achievable initiation/follow-up target and identify the actual provider windows. | Bank-credit timing is not entirely controlled by RCS. Accepted refunds must meet applicable reasonable/statutory timing. Do not promise an unverified fixed bank-credit date. |
| **7. Driver and vehicle checks — L07–L09** | Provide evidence of police/identity/medical/experience checks, PUC renewal, training and the applicable insurance/social-security arrangements. Identify which are manual. | A required control needs real evidence. Updating privacy/terms to say a document exists is not completion of the check. |
| **8. Retention and security — L12–L13, F02** | Decide category-specific purposes, custodians, legal holds, deletion processes, log location and incident owner. Reuse applicable existing retention work only after its scope is verified. | Separate transport data limits, security-log retention and financial/legal records. One global retention number cannot safely replace those categories. |
| **9. Territory and model — J01–J08** | Provide current fleet counts/ownership by territory, actual counterparties and the precise operating model. Resolve the entity/operating prerequisites and obtain the missing current state texts. | The confirmed eight-state/UT footprint requires jurisdiction-specific assessment. A local fleet threshold or vehicle permit is not a universal platform exemption. |

| Decision | Choices / facts needed | What is mandatory versus optional |
|---|---|---|
| **10. One policy version — D01–D03, D06, L14** | After the substantive choices above, choose one effective version and reconcile English, Hindi, Hinglish, native links, PDF and knowledge files. Define the captain agreement acceptance/version record. | Current false/stale disclosures should be corrected; an unapproved English candidate should not silently become the Hindi contract. |

For the next implementation request, answer by decision number, for example `1=A, 2=A, 4=current commission; owner-driven vehicles; daily settlement` and provide the requested factual evidence. Any unresolved mandatory-law question will remain explicit; it will not be replaced by an invented approval.